MONTHLY UPDATE

Central African Republic: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-12 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.*

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH · GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · DATA

Summary of the month

A fire damaged the electoral authority's data-processing centre in the week before 24 September, and an investigation was opened. The government signed a memorandum with AMINI on data, AI and security infrastructure, reported on 29 September, and created a communication-monitoring cell under the government spokesperson by presidential decree. The national component of the World Bank's Central Africa digital integration programme is to launch in April 2027.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

The digital development agency's own presentation establishes its footing: it was created by law in June 2023 as a public establishment with a mandate to implement the national digital strategy. No budget, staffing or activity report is held.

Legislation and regulation

The statistics institute reported that the bill replacing the statistics law of 16 July 2001 had passed technical validation and strategic review and awaits the commission that examines draft official texts.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

The government gave itself a unit to watch public debate. A presidential decree created a communication-monitoring cell under the government spokesperson, with a permanent secretariat and three units, one dedicated to crisis communication, to monitoring national and international media and social networks, and to countering rumours. Its staff are to be appointed by decree in Council of Ministers. The decree as reported sets no safeguard on how the monitoring is used, and no budget is published.

Finance

MoUs and other agreements

After President Touadéra met the founder of the data-infrastructure and AI company AMINI at the UN General Assembly, the national internet and security unit signed a cooperation memorandum with the company providing for a national data centre, a security operations centre, a national computer emergency response team and a digital twin of the mining subsoil, reported on 29 September. No cost, financing, site, timetable or data-hosting terms are published.

New investments

The regional programme acquired a date rather than money. The country's component of the Central Africa digital integration programme is to launch in April 2027, after a week of work in Bangui by a financier mission covering connectivity, public services, data and cybersecurity. No national allocation or workplan is published.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

The country's dependence on one neighbour was examined. A published assessment set out the options for reaching submarine cable capacity other than through Cameroon. For a landlocked country, the transit route is the bandwidth constraint. The assessment names alternatives; the record held carries no route secured, no agreement signed and no capacity figure.

The digital-economy minister and his Congolese counterpart agreed in Moscow on 8 October 2026 on the need to carry out a fibre interconnection with the Democratic Republic of Congo, which the ministry says would reach the submarine cable landing at Moanda; no timetable or financing was announced.

Data Storage

Fire damaged part of the national elections authority's data-processing centre in the week before 24 September, weeks ahead of the October residual elections. The government opened an investigation and says the vote will go ahead; no cause, damage estimate or continuity arrangement is stated.

DPI

Digital Payments and Fintech

The regulator's first-half 2026 market observatory counts more than 702,000 active mobile-money clients at the end of June 2026, from operators' returns.

Sectoral management information systems

The first integrated criminal database was established on 9 October 2026, the UN mission financing the centre, equipment and servers and UNODC providing expertise, training and connectivity; extension to the judicial police and the regions is the stated next step. A second report records the centre's inauguration at the interior ministry.

Technology

ICT Industry

The regulator published operators' combined revenue for the first half of 2026 in its market observatory. It is turnover reported to the regulator; no contribution to output, employment or firm count is held.

Capacity

Training and skills

The government signed a five-year partnership with Russia on 9 October 2026, implemented through HSE University, for digital-governance training of public servants, joint research and expert seminars.

Data

National statistics

The statistics institute posted the regulator's first-half 2026 market observatory on 16 September, compiled from the returns operators must file under the regulator's decision of 25 June 2025. It puts internet clients at more than 23% of the population.

The institute held the mid-term evaluation of the second national statistics strategy in Bangui on 7 to 9 October 2026, financed by UNDP; the strategy is to be updated with revised indicators and a realigned calendar.

Open data

At a CEMAC workshop in Libreville on 14 to 18 September, the statistics institute ICASEES presented its national plan for migrating its open data portal from ODP 1.0 to ODP 2.0 and demonstrated a locally installed ODP 2.0 test environment loaded with the national accounts. No migration date or public address for the new platform is published.

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